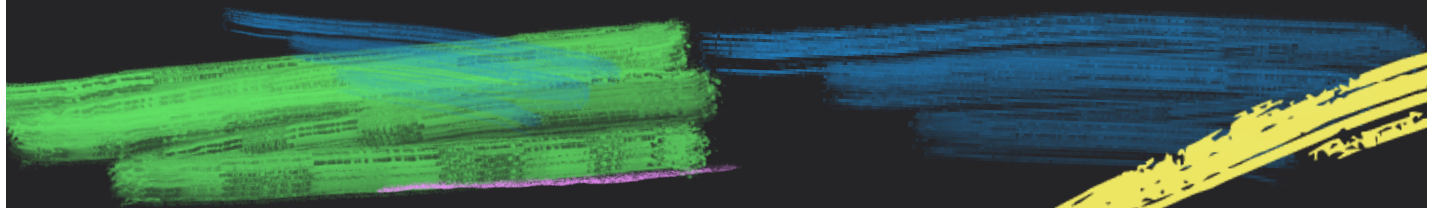




Close the basics. Lead with what only we do.

What our research found on wellness challenges, leaderboards and gamification: what Refresh already has, what worked for us with Vitality, what brings people back, and what to tackle now.

Strategy brief · about a 10-minute read · October 2026



What is in here. What we found in the October 5 admin review and on competitors' public pages, what brings people back on competitors' apps, what worked for us when we ran Vitality, the 11 items we'd tackle now, status tiers and the points receipt, and why we build rather than partner, with links to everything we cite. There is also a [PDF of this document](#).

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SECTION 1

What we found

Refresh already has most of what competitors offer in wellness challenges and leaderboards. Of the 11 gaps we'd close first, 1 already works, 1 is coming in Q4 2026, 4 start with turning on features Refresh already has, and 5 need building.

We reviewed the Goodwill NE Texas admin dashboard on October 5, 2026, went through the live NE Texas and Marion apps, read competitors' public pages and help centers, and compared it all with what worked for us when we ran Vitality. This brief covers **gamified wellness**: challenges, teams and leaderboards, points, status and badges. We say **location** for the places people work or are served: a store at Goodwill, a school at Somerset, a clinic or office elsewhere. Refresh already has:

- a challenge engine with step tracking, opt-in and solo modes, team views by tag, and a Daily Consistency calculation;
- points from challenges and shoutouts that redeem for gift cards, plus monthly drawings;
- peer shoutouts with point gifts and comments, which people actually use;
- guided quests and sequences worth points;
- **real services** (KOFÉ coaching, Findhelp, NeedyMeds and MemberDeals) that no competitor we looked at offers.

These are the gaps we'd close first:

1

Leaderboard privacy

Boards show full names today. Use "Solo Challenge" for personal challenges now; build first name and last initial display.

Turn on

Build now

2

Team and location boards

Team challenges are what kept people coming back in Vitality. Use "Teams by user tag" with the location tags already synced.

Turn on

3

Group goal challenge

Everyone adds to one shared target, so someone who joins late still counts from day one.

Build now

4

Streaks and "X of Y days"

Use the existing "Daily Consistency" calculation; build a visible streak and personal best.

Turn on

Build now

5

Status tiers with multipliers

Milestones move people from bronze to platinum, and a higher status earns more points to spend in the marketplace.

Build now

6

Points summary receipt

One screen that shows every point collected, where it came from, and each bonus applied.

Build now

7

Milestone badges

Badges awarded automatically for step milestones, streaks and completed challenges.

Build now

8

Likes and comments

Already in Refresh's pipeline. Comments exist on shoutouts today.

Coming Q4 2026

Build or partner

We build the game mechanics on the engine we already own and buy only the device-data connection. We don't partner with or resell a wellness platform. Step sync already works; confirm the sources and add devices through a data service only if clients ask.

Where we win

On their public pages, competitors offer content *about* financial, social and health wellbeing. Refresh connects people to actual help, serves the community as well as staff, and is free to nonprofits.

SECTION 2**What brings people back that we don't have yet**

Patterns we found on competitors' own pages and help centers that are built to bring people back again and again, set against Refresh today.

PATTERN	WHERE WE SAW IT	REFRESH TODAY	OUR MOVE
Automatic milestone badges	Vantage Fit: seven badge categories, including daily step levels, streaks, level-ups and challenge completion (help center)	No badges seen	Build now Section 6, #8
Challenge and team chat	MoveSpring: a group chat in every challenge, with photos, reactions and threads (help center). Wellable: community chat (site)	Shoutout comments; likes and comments Coming Q4 2026	Next after likes and comments land
Raffles for effort, not just winners	Wellable: weekly raffles for participants, which it says stretch a rewards budget (Teams of Two)	Monthly gift-card drawings	Turn on tie drawing entries to challenge points; confirm
Small and self-made teams	Wellable: a Teams of Two challenge. YuMuuv: start a team in one click and rename it any time (blog)	Teams by user tag (location, department)	Turn on Build now self-join and pairs
Seasonal, themed challenges	Wellable: 40+ ready-made challenges, including seasonal ones (example)	58 scheduled challenges on monthly themes	Have
Charity challenges	Wellable: a Charity Challenge (page)	No donating points to charity	Build now Section 6, #11
Virtual races	MoveSpring: Virtual Race and Team Virtual Race	No map or race	Next

SECTION 3

What worked for us before: Vitality

When we ran Vitality, people had a weekly menu of ways to earn points, up to a maximum for the week: wellness checkup visits, team engagement challenges, knowledge assessments with quizzes, and more.

What we saw. The mix got people excited, and they kept coming back week after week. Team challenges did the most, because newcomers could contribute right away, even when they joined a team at the midpoint of a challenge.

Here's each piece and where Refresh stands on it today.

WHAT WE RAN IN VITALITY	REFRESH TODAY	NEXT STEP
A weekly points menu with a maximum	Points from challenges and shoutouts, with a points ledger for admins; no weekly menu or cap seen	Build now Section 6, #7

WHAT WE RAN IN VITALITY	REFRESH TODAY	NEXT STEP
Wellness checkup visits	No checkup challenge seen; could run as a Form or Event challenge	Turn on confirm it can be logged
Team engagement challenges	"Teams by user tag" view; location and department tags already synced	Turn on Section 6, #3
Knowledge assessments with quizzes	"Content, Event, or Form" challenge type exists	Turn on confirm Forms can score answers
Newcomers contribute mid-challenge	Not seen in the review	Confirm late joiners count from the day they join
Bronze-to-platinum status	No status or badges seen in the review	Build now Section 6, #6 and #8

SECTION 4

Where Refresh stands today

From our October 5 review of the NE Texas admin dashboard and the live NE Texas and Marion apps.

AREA	WHAT REFRESH HAS NOW	GAP
Challenges	58 scheduled challenges (NE Texas), mostly weekly monthly-theme challenges plus monthly step challenges; Step Tracking and Content/Event/Form types; recurring, rolling and custom timeframes; Total or Daily Consistency; opt-in; availability by tag	No shared group goal; no map or virtual race
Guided programs	Quests and sequences worth points	None for launch
Points and rewards	Points from challenges and shoutouts; points redeem for gift cards (Amazon, Walmart); monthly drawings; redemptions log and points ledger	No weekly maximum, multipliers or points receipt for users seen; no donating points to charity
Status and badges	None seen in the review	No bronze-to-platinum status and no milestone badges; confirm with product
Social	Shoutouts tied to values and safety, with point gifts, images and comments; admin moderation; heavily used	Likes and comments Coming Q4 2026 ; no challenge or team chat
Leaderboards	Individual or "Teams by user tag" views; per-challenge "Solo" mode hides boards; location tags (stores, at NE Texas) and department tags already synced	Full names display; team views not yet set up; no "people near me" view
Step tracking	Working: step challenges show synced daily totals	Confirm which devices and apps feed it
Real services	KOFE, Findhelp, NeedyMeds Rx card, SNAP, LawHelp, crisis lines, career tools, MemberDeals	None: competitors lack this
Audiences	Workforce, Community and Public versions	Competitors serve employees only

SECTION 5

Who we compete with

What we read on competitors' public pages. The closest is Woliba, an all-in-one wellness, recognition and rewards app for companies of up to about 5,000 staff. Most others lead with one strength.

COMPETITOR	LEADS WITH	WHAT WE LEARN
Woliba	All-in-one: 120+ challenge types, recognition, surveys, events, health assessments, 40+ HR system connections	Its four tiers work as a roadmap. It charges only for employees who sign up.
Wellable	Challenges, recognition and a large rewards wallet	Teams of 3–8 with captains; raffle entries for effort
MoveSpring	Step and activity challenges	The clearest challenge menu; teams scored by average; daily caps
YuMuuv	Social team challenges	Broad device sync; community forums
Vantage Fit / Vantage Circle	Gamified challenges, perks, recognition	Automatic badges; sells white-label versions
Personify Health	Enterprise wellness and health navigation	Scale and health-plan ties
Recognition apps (Bucketlist, Guusto, Achievers, Bonusly, Nectar)	Peer recognition and rewards	Manager gift cards by text; points to charity; nominations

What we didn't find on any of their pages: a way to connect people to real local services (food, rent, prescriptions, legal help), serving the community as well as staff, or a free offer for nonprofits.

SECTION 6

What we'd tackle now

Each row says what we saw that puts it on the list.

#	ITEM	WHAT WE SAW	BUILD OR BUY
1	Leaderboard privacy First name + last initial, personal opt-out, "my rank only" on sensitive challenges, an on/off switch per challenge Turn onBuild now	Admin review: boards show full names; "Solo" mode already hides boards per challenge	Turn on Solo mode now; build first-name/last-initial display and "my rank only"

#	ITEM	WHAT WE SAW	BUILD OR BUY
2	Step sync: confirm and extend Apple Health and Health Connect first, then Fitbit and Garmin Have	Admin review: the October step challenge shows synced daily step totals; sources unconfirmed	Working today; confirm sources. Buy a data service for extra devices only if needed.
3	Teams and scoped boards Teams from HR data, self-join, a catch-all team; boards by organization, region, location and team; show me $\pm$ 5 neighbors Turn on	Vitality: team challenges kept people coming back. Admin review: location and department tags already synced	Use "Teams by user tag" with location tags; build average-per-member scoring and a "people near me" view if missing
4	Group goal challenge Everyone adds to one shared target Build now	Vitality: newcomers contributing right away made team challenges work	Build
5	Streaks, "X of Y days" and personal bests Turn on Build now	Admin review: the "Daily Consistency" calculation already exists	Use "Daily Consistency"; build a streak and personal-best display
6	Status tiers with multipliers Bronze, silver, gold and platinum reached through milestones; a higher status multiplies points earned for the marketplace (Section 7) Build now	Vitality uses bronze-to-platinum status. Admin review: no status seen	Build on the existing points ledger
7	Points summary receipt Every point collected by week, month and year, where it came from, and each bonus applied; a weekly maximum (Section 7) Build now	Vitality: a weekly menu with a maximum kept people coming back. Admin review: a points ledger exists for admins only	Build on the existing points ledger
8	Milestone badges Awarded automatically for step milestones, streaks and completed challenges Build now	Vantage Fit awards badges automatically in seven categories. Admin review: no badges seen	Build
9	Likes and comments Reactions and comments on posts and shoutouts Coming Q4 2026	In Refresh's pipeline. Admin review: comments already exist on shoutouts	Coming in Q4 2026; no action beyond confirming scope
10	Effort-based drawing entries Challenge points earn entries in the monthly drawing Turn on	Wellable runs weekly raffles for participants. Admin review: monthly drawings exist	Turn on, if drawings can use challenge points; confirm
11	Donate points to charity Let people turn points into a donation Build now	Wellable runs a Charity Challenge; recognition apps offer points to charity	Build

Points already redeem for gift cards. Keep the monthly drawing as a low-cost option; there's no need to build a larger rewards catalog.

Status tiers and the points receipt

Our proposal, modeled on Vitality's bronze-to-platinum status and on card programs like American Express Gold and Platinum, where a higher tier comes with richer rewards. Milestones move people up. The higher the status, the bigger the multiplier on every point earned, and the points are spent in the marketplace.

How status works

STATUS	HOW YOU REACH IT (EXAMPLE MILESTONES)	WHAT IT UNLOCKS (EXAMPLE)
Bronze	Join and finish your first challenge	Base points (× 1.0); marketplace gift cards
Silver	3 challenges finished and a 7-day streak	× 1.1 on every point earned
Gold	8 challenges finished, a 30-day streak and a team challenge completed	× 1.2 on every point earned; early access to new marketplace offers
Platinum	15 challenges finished and active in 9 of 12 months	× 1.3 on every point earned; marketplace items only Platinum members can redeem

The points summary receipt

One screen that shows every point a person has collected, where it came from, and each bonus applied, by week, month and year.

Your points

EXAMPLE

This week

This month

This year

Location team step challenge · 5 of 7 days

250

Wellness checkup logged

200

Quiz: know your benefits

100

Shoutout received

50

Earned

600

Streak bonus · 7 days in a row × 1.25

+150

Gold status × 1.2

+150

This week

900 of 1,000 max

STATUS

Bronze

Silver

Gold

Platinum

Gold: 3 more challenges to Platinum.

STREAK BONUS

3 days × 1.1

7 days × 1.25

14+ days × 1.5

SPEND IT

Points redeem for gift cards in the marketplace, as they do today.

SECTION 8

How we'd run team challenges and leaderboards

Teams	Scoring	Leaderboards
- Let people join mid-challenge and contribute right away. In Vitality, this is what made team challenges work for newcomers. - Built from HR data (location, department, region), with self-join and a catch-all team. - At least 3–4 members, ideally 4–8; pairs for Teams of Two challenges. - Optional captains; location leads take part visibly.	- Rank teams by average per member, not total. - Count active members only. - A daily cap (for example, 20,000 steps). - Data no more than a day old, plus an end-of-challenge grace period. - Capped manual entry and an activity converter for people without trackers.	- Scopes: organization, region, location, team; the default is "my location" or "my team." - Show me plus five people above and below. - First name and last initial; opt out as "Teammate"; sensitive challenges show only my rank. - A Personal tab with streak, personal best, status and badges. - Effort earns drawing entries. - An admin switch per challenge already exists (Solo mode). Add a "my rank only" option.

Challenge types

Status Have Turn on Coming Q4 2026 Build now Next Later Skip

TYPE	STATUS	
Target	Have	
Streak	Turn on	Daily Consistency + Build now streak display
X of Y days	Turn on	Daily Consistency; confirm
Individual leaderboard	Have	fix name display
Group goal	Build now	
Team leaderboard	Turn on	Teams by user tag
Habit check-ins	Have	
Knowledge quiz	Turn on	Form challenge; confirm scoring
Wellness checklist	Turn on	Form or Event challenge; confirm

TYPE	STATUS
Virtual race or map	Next

SECTION 9

What comes next

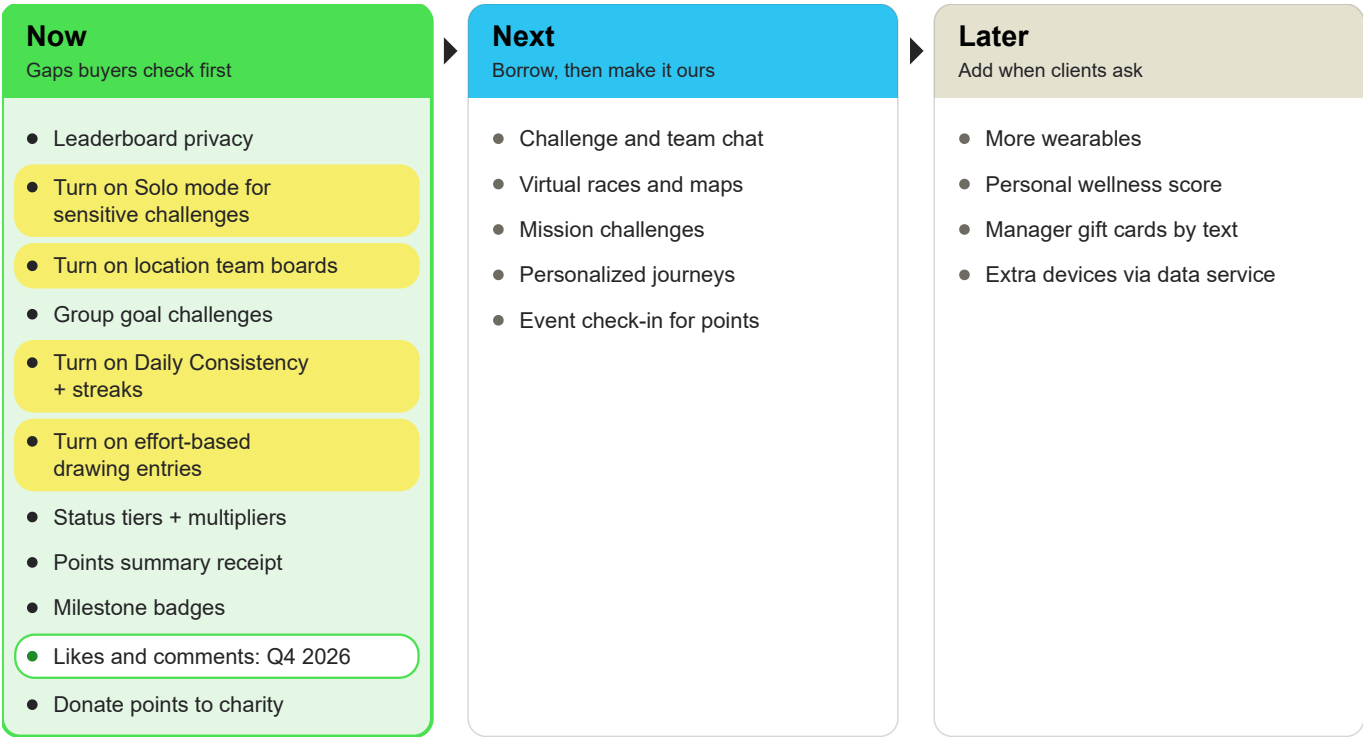
Borrow what competitors do well, then reshape it around our services and mission.

FEATURE	REFRESH'S VERSION
Challenge and team chat Next	A chat in each challenge and team, with photos and reactions, once likes and comments land in Q4 2026
Virtual races and maps Next	"Walk the route between our locations"
Mission challenges Next	"Every 1,000 steps funds an hour of job training"; group goals tied to the mission
Personalized journeys Next	Extend what exists: sequences, "choose a wellness focus," and availability by tag. Add journeys by role, location and need.
Event check-in for points Next	QR check-in at events earns points toward status
Later	More wearables, a personal wellness score, manager gift cards by text

Roadmap at a glance

Close the basics now, then add the status and rewards that bring people back

Sequence only: no dates or durations. Items in yellow already exist in Refresh and need turning on; the outlined item is already in Refresh's pipeline.



SECTION 11

Where we win, and what we skip

Lead with

- Real services, not articles.
- Three audiences: workforce, community and public.
- Built for frontline staff: personal-email sign-in, text, QR, push and language choice.
- Points that people can spend, with status that makes them worth more.
- Free to nonprofits.
- Mission challenges tied to what the organization does.

Skip or leave to partners Skip

- Biometric screening and condition programs (leave to the health plan).
- On-demand fitness class libraries (link to free apps).
- Reporting for boards and funders.
- Lifestyle spending accounts and physical awards.

SECTION 12

Build, partner or learn

The decision. Build the game mechanics, buy only the device-data connection, keep partnering for services, and learn from wellness platforms without partnering with them.

OPTION	VERDICT	WHY
Build it ourselves	Yes: challenges, teams, leaderboards, status, badges, the points receipt	Every gap extends the engine and points ledger we already own
Buy a component	Yes: extra devices only	Phone sync must be native app code anyway. A data service covers Fitbit, Garmin and others; per-user pricing adds up at our scale, so negotiate or build later.
Partner with or resell a wellness platform	No	Heavy overlap, a second app, per-user fees that conflict with the donated model, and no visible reseller program
Partner for services	Yes, keep doing it	KOFE, NeedyMeds, Findhelp and MemberDeals plug into Refresh and keep it the hub
Learn and do something different	Yes	Use competitors' patterns and what worked in Vitality as a checklist; build our version around needs, services and mission

SECTION 13

What we still need to confirm

- ☐ Which devices and apps feed step tracking (Apple Health, Health Connect, Fitbit, Garmin).
- ☐ Whether employees can see "Teams by user tag" boards in the app, or only admins.
- ☐ How team scores are calculated (total vs. average per member).
- ☐ Whether people who join a team mid-challenge count from the day they join.
- ☐ How "Daily Consistency" works (streak, or X of Y days).
- ☐ Whether leaderboard names can show first name and last initial.
- ☐ What the Q4 2026 likes and comments release covers: shoutouts only, or challenges and posts too.
- ☐ Whether Refresh has any status or badges today.
- ☐ Whether points rules can support a weekly maximum, streak bonuses and status multipliers, and whether multipliers apply when points are earned or redeemed.
- ☐ Whether status resets each year or carries over.
- ☐ Whether monthly drawing entries can be tied to challenge points.
- ☐ Whether Form challenges can score quiz answers and log wellness checkups.
- ☐ Privacy and agreement review for leaderboards and step data, run in parallel.

SECTION 14

Links

The services, programs and competitors named in this brief.

Services Refresh connects people to

KOFE

Financial education and one-on-one coaching from Consolidated Credit. · consolidatedcredit.org/financial-wellness-program

Findhelp

Free and reduced-cost local services, searchable by where a person lives. · findhelp.org

NeedyMeds

Prescription savings card and medication assistance programs. · needymeds.org

SNAP

The Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, from the USDA. · fns.usda.gov/snap

LawHelp.org

Referrals to free legal aid in every state. · lawhelp.org

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

One of the crisis lines in the app. · 988lifeline.org

MemberDeals

Employee discounts. · memberdeals.com

Programs we learned from

Vitality

Bronze-to-platinum status earned with points. Our team ran it before. · vitalitygroup.com

Competitor pages we cite

Vantage Fit: badges

Seven badge categories, awarded automatically. · vantagefit.io/en/help/health-tracking/what-are-badges

MoveSpring: chat

Group chat in every challenge, with photos and reactions. · help.movespring.com/en/articles/3204481-using-the-chat-feature-in-movespring

Wellable: challenges

Ready-made challenges and community chat. · wellable.co/wellness-challenges

Wellable: Teams of Two

Pairs, with weekly raffles for participants. · wellable.co/employee-wellness-challenges/teams-of-two-challenge

Wellable: Charity Challenge

A challenge built around giving. · wellable.co/employee-wellness-challenges/charity-challenge

YuMuuv: teams

One-click teams that members can rename. · yumuuu.com/blog/enhanced-teams-functionality-in-employee-challenges

Competitors we learn from

Woliba

The closest competitor: all-in-one wellness, recognition and rewards. · woliba.io

Wellable

Challenges, recognition and a rewards wallet. · wellable.co

MoveSpring

Step and activity challenges. The site now redirects to Reward Gateway. · movespring.com

YuMuuv

Social team challenges. · yumuuu.com

Vantage Fit

Gamified wellness challenges. · vantagefit.io

Vantage Circle

Perks and recognition. · vantagecircle.com

Personify Health

Enterprise wellness and health navigation. · personifyhealth.com

Bucketlist

Recognition and rewards. · bucketlistrewards.com

Guusto

Recognition and rewards. · guusto.com

Achievers

Recognition and rewards. · achievers.com

Bonusly

Recognition and rewards. · bonusly.com

Nectar

Recognition and rewards. · nectarhr.com



Refresh Software, Inc. · REACH · Public-Serving Division. Draft materials for review. Named organizations illustrate partner and provider types.

Competitor details come from their public marketing and help pages, October 2026. Vitality notes come from our team's experience running the program. Status tiers, multipliers and the points receipt are illustrative proposals.